

AI for Founders

Where your edge lives

When a capability becomes universal, generic competence stops being an advantage. So where does your edge actually live?

Show of hands – who's used AI on their idea this week?



While you arrive – one question:

which best describes you and AI, right now?

classpulse.borck.education/audience/RXARHX



Slides are signposts – the site is the handout.

Prompts, tools, and this deck: michael-borck.github.io/ai-for-founders

The same tool, every room.

- A capability that drafts your copy, models your numbers, and rehearses your pitch can do the same for **every other founder in the room**.
- Generic competence is the **baseline** — not the advantage.
- The edge lives in your **judgement**: taste, context, and the variation no rival's identical model can reproduce.

Walk the talk.

- One academic, in conversation with AI: **~30 tools** designed, built, and shipped solo — bigpicture.borck.dev.
- AI taught at **undergraduate, postgraduate, and executive** levels at Curtin — the books are free at books.borck.education.
- This deck, the companion site, and the poll you just answered were **built in conversation with AI**.

Sycophancy

The model tells you what you *want* to hear. Ask “what do you think of my pitch?” and you get praise first, gentle critique second.

It’s managing your feelings, not assessing your work.

Defence: `prompt past it → move 2`

05 • TRAP TWO • THE ONE THAT COSTS MONEY

Gell-Mann amnesia

You catch its errors in *your* domain — then trust it on the market, the regs, the numbers, the bits you can't check.

Smooth prose feels authoritative. Smoothness $\neq$ accuracy.

Free chat. No subscription, nothing to install.

open one: gemini.google.com • chatgpt.com • claude.ai

MOVE 1

Validate

RTCF, two-pass.

MOVE 2

Pressure-test

Past the flattery.

MOVE 3

Sharpen the pitch

Two-pass, in your voice.

Run each on YOUR idea, in parallel with the tradie demo – or just watch. Both work.

Sensitive idea? Work the tradie example today – run yours tonight in Msty (one install, nothing leaves your laptop).



Follow along – today's prompts, top of the site.
michael-borck.github.io/ai-for-founders

07 · MOVE 1 · VALIDATE

The two-pass reveal.

PASS 1 · NAIVE

An enthusiastic, over-long love-fest. *Sycophancy, live.*

PASS 2 · WITH EDGE

Role · Task · **Context** · Format.

Context is where your edge enters. No model supplies it.

Past the flattery.

“Do not flatter me. Three reasons this fails. Name the load-bearing assumption.”

Then make the call:

Scale

Pivot

Kill

And the single cheapest experiment that moves it up a notch. Killing is a good outcome.

09 • MOVE 3 • SHARPEN THE PITCH

Generic vs. yours.

PASS 1

Generic 60-word pitch. Forgettable.

PASS 2

In *your* voice, leading with the one thing only **you** would say.

Three ways to push back.

CRITIQUE

Devil's advocate

Make it attack your idea. You decide what survives. *You just did this in move 2.*

PERSPECTIVE

Board of directors

A room of voices — cautious CFO, sceptical customer, growth marketer. Not one answer: you weigh them.

VERIFY

VET

Verify the source · Explain it back · Test the edges. For any claim you can't check.

Prompts for all three are on your companion site.

Average / Precise × Small / Large.

Lean in

- Competitor scans
- Brainstorming
- First drafts

Human owns it

- The go/no-go
- The customer
- Any number in a pitch

Where it hurts to be wrong, you stay in charge.

When the grid says verify → VET it

12 • THE METHOD, IN THREE SENTENCES

- 01 **Add context** — the specifics only you hold.
- 02 **Prompt past the flattery** — ask “why does this fail?”, not “what do you think?”
- 03 **Stay sceptical** where you know least.

AI as a thinking partner, not a stand-in.

- The **companion site** — RTCF builder, prompt library, trust tool + VET.
- The **starter prompts** — copy-paste, from today.
- **Tonight:** run move 1 on your real idea.
- The tools: today's free chat, **Gemini Notebook** for your documents, **Msty** for private local AI — all linked on the site.

Direct it. / Don't delegate. / Never surrender.



Companion site — prompts, tools, this deck.
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